Nevada Hamaker

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I started in technical support, transitioned to software testing, and then to a full-time software development role. My experience spans back-end and front-end testing and development, web services, databases, cloud infrastructure, and use of AI coding tools. My recent work has focused on ecommerce platform customization, migration of services and databases to Google Cloud Platform, and full-stack development using Java, PHP, React, TypeScript, GraphQL, and MySQL.

Technical Skills

Programming: PHP, Java, Spring Boot, JavaScript/TypeScript
Web & Cloud: React, Magento, GraphQL, Google Cloud Platform, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Kafka
Databases: MySQL/MariaDB, Cloud SQL
DevOps: CI/CD, GitHub Actions, New Relic

Professional Experience

October 2025 - February 2026
Senior Software Engineer | *BFG Entertainment, Inc.*

Continued in the same role on the engineering team following the acquisition of the Big Fish Games downloadable games business by BFG Entertainment.

The major project I worked on was the complete rebuild of the Big Fish Games website front end using PWA Studio as its base. This replaced the previous front end implemented in Adobe Experience Manager. The new site is a pure, React-based progressive web application that communicates with the Magento back end using GraphQL and REST. Replacing AEM resulted in substantial cost savings for the company. The new front end significantly improved performance and responsiveness and the new codebase allowed for faster iteration of fixes and new features.

My accomplishments during this project include:

- Replaced or extended many of the existing React components and implemented several new ones. For example, I implemented a new “Promotional Content Block” component that is used by the Marketing team to display banners or other promotional material. It can choose from several different content blocks to display based on conditions including whether the customer has made any purchases and whether the customer is a member of Game Club.
- Adapted and extended existing GraphQL queries used by the front end and implemented new ones.
- Extended the Magento back end with new GraphQL resolvers for product and customer data to support custom functionality that was implemented in the new front end.

During this project, AI coding tools (Claude Code in particular) became truly useful. They accelerated customization, new feature implementation, GraphQL integration, and styling updates for the new front end. They allowed us to release it to production ahead of schedule and quickly follow up with updates and fixes. I continued to learn where my own judgment was still important and when to push back or change course.

Technologies used include: Adobe PWA Studio, Magento, React, GraphQL, PHP, JavaScript, TypeScript, MySQL/MariaDB, Composer, Yarn, GitHub Actions, New Relic, Claude Code.

January 2022 - October 2025
Senior Software Engineer | *Big Fish Games, Inc.*

Promoted from Senior Software Design Engineer in Test to Senior Software Engineer after progressively taking on development responsibilities for the back-end web services that supported Big Fish's mobile and downloadable games businesses.

I worked on several projects, the largest of which was the modernization of the Big Fish Games ecommerce platform. We transitioned it from an on-premises stack developed in-house to a managed cloud-based architecture built on Adobe Magento and Adobe Experience Manager. This substantially reduced our footprint in the local data center, enabled faster and easier deployments, improved monitoring capabilities, and eliminated PCI-compliance responsibilities.

My accomplishments in this role include:

- Implemented substantial Magento customization and back-end service integrations to support our unique business requirements.
- Integrated and customized multiple Magento extensions to expand its capabilities and tailor functionality to support the Big Fish Games business needs.
- Integrated Magento with Klaviyo, including extending the Klaviyo extension for Magento and implementing additional custom code. This replaced Salesforce and allowed Big Fish to better manage email marketing campaigns.
- Adapted Magento and the existing authentication service to work together using SAML SSO, including custom logic for post-login redirects.
- Led the migration of multiple existing services and databases to Google Cloud Platform (Kubernetes Engine, Cloud Run, Cloud SQL). I performed the first service and database migrations, established the procedures used for subsequent migrations, and assisted other engineers in carrying them out.
- Designed and implemented a containerized Cloud Run service to integrate legacy purchase and customer data into the Magento platform, and to process and publish telemetry events to Google PubSub. This allowed customers to retain access to games they had purchased before the transition.
- Updated the DRM back-end service used for activation of games, making code and database changes to improve stability, fix longstanding issues, and enable tighter integration with Magento.
- Contributed to development of the AEM front end, including implementation of the order history and game library pages.
- Contributed to the cross-platform Game Manager client application, a hybrid of C++/Objective-C++ and HTML/JavaScript/CSS. Fixed bugs, removed deprecated functionality, and updated authentication flows on both Mac and Windows.

Technologies used include: Magento, Adobe Experience Manager, PHP, Java, Spring Boot, JavaScript, TypeScript, Xcode, MySQL/MariaDB, Google Cloud Platform, Klaviyo, Terraform, Docker, Composer, npm, Maven, GitHub Actions, New Relic, Google Cloud Logging.

November 2010 - January 2022
Senior Software Design Engineer in Test | *Big Fish Games, Inc.*

My first project was testing the Big Fish Games website, an ecommerce stack developed in-house for the downloadable games business, using a combination of manual and automated testing. Later, I transitioned to testing a considerable number of web services that were developed to support the growing mobile games business. These services supported player communications, marketing and promotions, and player segmentation. They also included a high-volume event data pipeline based on Kafka, including the services

that received events from games and published them to event topics, the application that consumed those events and processed them, and the large, sharded MySQL database that stored the resulting data.

My accomplishments in this role include:

- Architected, expanded, and maintained test automation framework and test case library for the Big Fish Games website, written in Python and built on Selenium, significantly improving test coverage.
- Expanded and maintained Java-based automation framework and test case library for the back-end services, significantly improving test coverage.
- Contributed directly to production web-service code and collaborated closely with developers. I progressively took on back-end development responsibilities that led to a formal transition to the Senior Software Engineer role.
- Designed and implemented a standalone microservice as part of a larger project, gaining hands-on experience with service design, integration, and deployment considerations.
- Implemented a utility written in C# which translated save game data for one of Big Fish's mobile games to and from its compressed binary format to support customer service's ability to update customers' save data as needed.
- Managed branch operations and CI/CD releases in a continuous delivery environment.

Technologies used include: Python, Java, Spring Boot, Dropwizard, JavaScript, PHP, Selenium, Jenkins, Docker, Kafka, Kubernetes, Google Cloud Platform, Redis, Memcache, Git, SVN, Mercurial, JIRA, Confluence, Kibana, and more.

August 2010 - September 2010
Software Design Engineer in Test | *Mantis Technology Group, Inc.*

- Created automation for testing a WCF Service for a client, delivering 120 automated test cases in 3.5 weeks and authoring project documentation.

September 2009 - August 2010
Software Design Engineer in Test | *Populus Group/Microsoft*

- Contract role on the Microsoft Mobile Services Platform team.
- Tested Microsoft Mobile Services Platform (MSP) SOAP services. Developed and maintained automation written in C#, and validated production systems.

February 2009 - July 2009
Software Design Engineer in Test | *Sage IT/Getty Images*

- Contract role at Getty Images on the Partner Portal team.
- Tested new digital asset storage and web services for Getty Images and validated Partner Portal features.

August 2007 - January 2009
Software Test Engineer/Software Design Engineer in Test | *Electronic Evidence Discovery, Inc.*

- Tested web and Windows applications, co-architected automated test framework in C#, and maintained build deployment systems.

August 2006 - August 2007
Software Design Engineer in Test | *Excell Data Corporation/Microsoft*

- Contract role at Microsoft on the SharedView team.
- Led migration to new UI test automation framework for SharedView. Expanded coverage of C# test automation and created technical documentation.

June 2000 - July 2006
Software Test Engineer/Software Design Engineer in Test | *Microsoft Corporation*

- Member of the Visio product team.
- Tested major Visio functionality including printing, database connectivity, the Database Modeling Diagram solution, and Shape Search.
- Implemented automated testing of online shape search feature.
- Drove Windows compatibility and Logo compliance.

1996 - June 2000
Software Test Engineer | *Asymetrix/Click2Learn*

- Member of the ToolBook product team
- Tested multiple versions of ToolBook.
- Developed automation using OpenScript programming language.

Education

Bachelor of Science degree in Math/Computer Science, Western Washington University, 1993